David Antonio Ortega Alfaro

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Economist and data scientist with 4+ years leading analytics teams in Mexican government and banking, building dashboards, geolocated maps, and daily data reports for senior decision-makers. Columbia SIPA MPA student (economic & urban policy) with a strong interest in data visualization and visual journalism.

EDUCATION

Columbia University, New York City 2026–2028

MPA, International Finance and Economic Policy:

Minor in data science and urban policy.

Coursework: Corporate Finance, International Capital Markets, Monetary Theory, Financial Risk Management.

ITAM, Mexico City 2016–2022

B.S. Economics and B.A. Political Science (double major, *licenciatura*). Merit award (Honors equivalent).

Coursework: econometrics, causal inference, financial modeling, accounting fundamentals, survey design.

Research assistant to PhD candidates from Harvard, Stanford, and UNC Chapel Hill.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Prosecutor's Office, Mexico City 2025–2026

Analytics Director

- Built real-time dashboards for prosecutors to track policy changes and performance metrics.
- Supported a new crime reporting system with geolocated crime mapping, replacing a manual process run by ∼10 people daily (100+ staff hours saved weekly).
- Led a five-person team reporting to the Prosecutor General and Chief of Criminal Policy; produced monitoring reports on detentions, arrest warrants, trial outcomes, and seizures that supported criminal-policy changes.

Agency for Digital Transformation and Telecom., Mexico City 2024–2025

Analytics Director

- Built data pipelines turning disaggregated tax-collection and criminal data into daily reports for the President, cutting turnaround from monthly assessments to daily.
- Mapped water-system deficiencies, forecast state-level adoption of school scholarship programs, and built dashboards for officials rolling out social programs.
- Led a cross-functional team of six data scientists delivering analytics and machine-learning work across security, education, and economic policy.

Banorte, Mexico City 2023–2024

Data Scientist

- Developed credit-risk models (XGBoost, LightGBM) to estimate defaults and guide credit-line extensions, improving default-prediction accuracy by 10%.
- Applied difference-in-differences and propensity-score matching to evaluate marketing ROI and inform allocation of more than $5M in advertising.
- Designed A/B tests for digital banking product launches to measure credit take-up.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming and Tools: Python, R, SQL, Shiny, Tableau, Git, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MS Office

Quantitative Methods: Econometrics, A/B testing, regression analysis, time series, machine learning

Financial and Business Analysis: Credit risk, VAR modeling, pricing and product analysis, KPI monitoring.

Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Native), French (Intermediate)

RESEARCH AND PROJECTS

Publication: "Externalities from Public Transportation Infrastructure."

MIT Applied Data Science Program: Machine learning, deep learning, NLP, and model deployment; built emotion-recognition image analysis and random forest classifiers with Hugging Face models. Credential

Interests: Photography and writing (see website), marathon finisher and track runner, Wong Kar-wai and Paul Thomas Anderson films, David Foster Wallace, prediction markets.